Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Legislation and regulation

- **Nigeria's telecom operators sue federal lawmakers over service-quality probe** — TechCabal, 9 November 2026 NIGERIA

  ALTON and four Nigerian operators filed a summons at the Federal High Court in Abuja on 4 November 2026, TechCabal reported. They ask whether the Constitution lets the House of Representatives investigate their network quality and summon their chiefs. The House says each operator holds its own licence and must account for its performance. *Also under Connectivity.*

- **Côte d'Ivoire : ce que la nouvelle loi bancaire change pour les fintechs** — Banque Finance Magazine, 9 November 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  The economic and finance committee of Côte d'Ivoire's National Assembly unanimously adopted the banking regulation bill on 4 November 2026. The bill transposes the UMOA uniform banking law of 16 June 2023 and places fintechs, payment institutions and electronic-money issuers in one framework with banks. It also admits Islamic finance and adds an early-intervention mechanism. The bill still has to complete its passage before promulgation. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

Regional collaboration

- **South Africa participates in the 2026 International Telecommunication Union Plenipotentiary Conference in Doha, Qatar** — South African Government, 9 November 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa is seeking re-election to the ITU Council at the Plenipotentiary Conference in Doha, which runs from 9 to 27 November 2026. Its delegation is led by the Department of Communications and Digital Technologies. For the 2027-2030 term it pledges to support digital public infrastructure, submarine-cable resilience and the safe use of AI. *Also under Connectivity.*

- **Liberia Regains ATU Voting Rights After U.S.$400k Debt Waiver** — The Liberian Investigator via allAfrica, 9 November 2026 LIBERIA

  Liberia has regained its voting rights in the African Telecommunications Union, the telecoms regulator's chair Clarence K. Massaquoi said on 9 November 2026. A waiver of more than US$400,000 and a government payment of the balance ended its observer status. He gave neither the amount paid nor the date the rights were restored. *Also under Connectivity and Access to services.*

- **ECOWAS Heads of Immigration sign Freetown Declaration to mandate ENBIC acceptance by January 1, 2027** — ECOWAS Commission, 9 November 2026 WEST AFRICA

ECOWAS Heads of Immigration adopted the Freetown Declaration on 4 November 2026. Member states commit to accept any valid ECOWAS National Biometric Identity Card at official border crossings from 1 January 2027, whether or not the issuing state has started its own rollout. National rollout plans are due to the Commission by December 2030. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS.*

- **AI, satellites, spectrum take centre stage as ITU resets global telecom priorities** — BusinessDay NG, 9 November 2026 GLOBAL

  The ITU Plenipotentiary Conference opened in Doha on 9 November 2026, with 194 member states meeting over three weeks. Delegates elect the Union's leadership from 12 November, along with 12 Radio Regulations Board members and 48 Council members. They also approve the ITU's 2028-2031 strategic and financial plans, amid contests over spectrum, satellite coordination and AI. *Also under Connectivity.*

- **African Union Concludes 6th Ordinary Session of the Specialized Technical Committee on Education, Science and Technology** — African Union Commission, 9 November 2026 AFRICA

  African Union ministers of education, science and technology met in Addis Ababa on 6 November 2026. They cleared five sectoral AI publications for national adaptation. They asked AUDA-NEPAD and an advisory group for a continental semiconductor strategy to 2034. They also asked the AU Commission for a reporting portal on 60 CESA indicators. *Also under AI and National statistics.*

Standards

- **"Build Once, Use Across Government": Mauritania's GovStack Journey** — GovStack, 9 November 2026 MAURITANIA

  GovStack reported on 9 November 2026 on two years of work with Mauritania, ITU, GIZ and the digital transformation ministry. In 2025 more than 30 officials from four ministries prototyped a company-registration service for the social security fund. In March 2026, 118 officials from 34 departments agreed a reference framework for shared architecture and service design. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Training and skills.*

- **ISO - SSMO - Sudanese Standards and Metrology Organization** — International Organization for Standardization, 9 November 2026 SUDAN

  The ISO membership page, on file under 9 November 2026, lists the Sudanese Standards and Metrology Organization as a member body. It describes a government body set up in 1993, with headquarters in Khartoum, state offices and 15 laboratories, and lists its memberships of regional and international standards bodies. The page carries no date of its own.

- **ISO - SAZ - Standards Association of Zimbabwe** — International Organization for Standardization, 9 November 2026 ZIMBABWE

  The ISO membership page, on file under 9 November 2026, lists the Standards Association of Zimbabwe as a member body. It describes a non-profit body formed in 1957 that publishes national standards, runs testing and certification, and serves as the WTO TBT enquiry point. It shows participation in 39 technical committees and observer status in 35.

- **ISO - MSB - Mauritius Standards Bureau** — International Organization for Standardization, 9 November 2026 MAURITIUS

  The ISO membership page, on file under 9 November 2026, lists the Mauritius Standards Bureau as a member body. It describes a bureau that develops standards, provides testing, calibration and certification, and keeps national measurement standards. It shows participation in 34 technical committees and observer status in 28.

- **ISO - IANOR - Institut Algérien de Normalisation** — International Organization for Standardization, 9 November 2026 ALGERIA

  The ISO membership page, on file under 9 November 2026, lists the Institut Algérien de Normalisation as a member body. It sets out the institute's tasks, including national standards development, the WTO TBT information point and the Algerian conformity mark. It shows participation in 27 technical committees and observer status in 50.

- **ISO - ESWASA - Eswatini Standards Authority** — International Organization for Standardization, 9 November 2026 ESWATINI

  The ISO membership page, on file under 9 November 2026, lists the Eswatini Standards Authority as a correspondent member of ISO. It describes a body that opened on 2 April 2007, has sixteen staff and is governed by a ten-member Council. Its technical department holds an information centre, a standards development unit and a testing unit.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **Intelligence artificielle et langues nationales : Le Burkina Faso face au défi des données linguistiques** — leFaso.net, 9 November 2026 BURKINA FASO

  A panel at the second Le Faso Digital in Burkina Faso, reported on 9 November 2026, discussed whether AI can handle Mooré, Dioula and Fulfuldé. The speakers said translation, transcription and voice tools exist but remain approximate. They named the shortage of digitised data, spelling harmonisation, and the need for computer scientists, linguists and public authorities to work together. *Also under AI.*

Finance

New investments

- **Announcing the launch of the GSMA Innovation Fund for AI-Enabled Financial Health** — GSMA, 9 November 2026 GLOBAL

  The GSMA launched an Innovation Fund for AI-Enabled Financial Health on 9 November 2026, funded by the UK Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office. It offers grants of GBP 100,000 to 250,000 to small and growing enterprises in low- and middle-income countries in Africa, South Asia and Southeast Asia. Applications close on 17 December 2026. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech and AI.*

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **WACS cable repairs enter critical phase** — ITWeb Africa, 9 November 2026 CONGO DRC

  Congo Telecom said a repair vessel was due on 11 November 2026 at the WACS fault between the two Congos. A disruption on 29 October cut its primary circuits. The operator said failover to backup links kept customers connected. It listed earlier WACS outages in 2020, August 2023 and January 2026.

- **MTN Group Earnings Outpace Revenue by 22.9% as Nigeria and Ghana Drive Q3 Growth** — Tech Africa News, 9 November 2026 NIGERIA GHANA SOUTH AFRICA AFRICA

MTN Group's update for the nine months to 30 September 2026 put service revenue at R176.2 billion, up 17.2% in constant currency, and EBITDA at R86.0 billion, up 22.9%. Nigeria and Ghana led the growth. The group counted 323.0 million customers and 70.3 million active Mobile Money users, with fintech transaction value up 36.9% to US$512.5 billion. *Also under ICT Industry and Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **IXPs list — The African IXP Association** — African IXP Association (AF-IX), 9 November 2026 ANGOLA BENIN BOTSWANA BURKINA FASO BURUNDI CAMEROON CÔTE D'IVOIRE DRC DJIBOUTI EGYPT GABON GAMBIA GHANA GUINEA KENYA LESOTHO LIBERIA MADAGASCAR MALAWI MALI MAURITIUS MOZAMBIQUE NAMIBIA NIGERIA CONGO RWANDA SENEGAL SOMALIA SOUTH AFRICA SUDAN TANZANIA TOGO TUNISIA UGANDA ZAMBIA ZIMBABWE AFRICA

  The African IXP Association's page, on file under 9 November 2026, lists Internet exchange points by country and city with the year each opened. Entries include Angola-IXP in Luanda (2006), Benin IX in Cotonou (2013) and the Kinshasa exchange KINIX in the DRC (2012). The page carries no date of its own.

- **Econet Burundi Invests $6.5 Million in Solar-Powered Telecom Network** — Tech Africa News, 9 November 2026 BURUNDI

  Econet Wireless Burundi broke ground in Bujumbura on 5 November 2026 on solar power for its network. The USD 2.5 million first phase of a USD 6.5 million programme covers about a third of its sites by July 2027. GEFI Solutions SEZ arranged the financing under a CRDB Bank guarantee. The company targets renewable power across the network by December 2028. *Also under Energy.*

- **South Africa participates in the 2026 International Telecommunication Union Plenipotentiary Conference in Doha, Qatar** — South African Government, 9 November 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

- **Nigeria's telecom operators sue federal lawmakers over service-quality probe** — TechCabal, 9 November 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

- **Liberia Regains ATU Voting Rights After U.S.$400k Debt Waiver** — The Liberian Investigator via allAfrica, 9 November 2026 LIBERIA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

- **AI, satellites, spectrum take centre stage as ITU resets global telecom priorities** — BusinessDay NG, 9 November 2026 GLOBAL

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Data Storage

- **Ghana and US Explore Digital Investment Partnerships in Data Centres and Cloud Infrastructure** — Tech Africa News, 9 November 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations, Samuel Nartey George, met a US Embassy delegation led by incoming Ambassador Faris Asad, reported on 9 November 2026. They discussed investment in data centres and cloud infrastructure through Amazon Web Services, cybersecurity and skills. The report records no commitment. *Also under US / hyperscaler activities.*

Energy

- **Econet Burundi Invests $6.5 Million in Solar-Powered Telecom Network** — Tech Africa News, 9 November 2026 BURUNDI

  Summarised under Connectivity.

Cybersecurity

- **Sierra Leone Begins Training Government ICT Officers on Website Management and Security** — Tech Africa News, 9 November 2026 SIERRA LEONE

  Sierra Leone's Ministry of Communication, Technology and Innovation began training ICT officers from ministries, departments and agencies on website management and security, reported on 9 November 2026. Under its Website Standardisation Framework the ministry builds and hosts official sites on shared gov.sl infrastructure, and the officers maintain content. The first phase ran two days, and further phases are planned. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Training and skills.*

- **CYBERCRIMINALITÉ - Les États-Unis renforcent la coopération judiciaire** — L'Express de Madagascar, 9 November 2026 MADAGASCAR

  Madagascar and the United States signed a judicial cooperation agreement against cybercrime on 6 November 2026 in Washington. Madagascar's justice minister signed with Jeanine Pirro, US prosecutor for the District of Columbia. Pirro heads the Scam Center Strike Force. A US Justice Department report credited FBI cooperation with dismantling 13 scam centres in Madagascar. *Also under US / hyperscaler activities.*

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Moroccans abroad can now apply online for criminal record certificates** — Hespress, 9 November 2026 MOROCCO

  Morocco's General Directorate of National Security opened its Epolice portal on 9 November 2026 to Moroccans abroad applying online for criminal-record certificates. Each request can be tracked online and the certificate is collected at the chosen diplomatic mission. The Ministry of Foreign Affairs, African Cooperation and Moroccan Expatriates built the service with the directorate. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Malawi's Nzika digital ID bounced at the bank** — Malawi24, 9 November 2026 MALAWI

  Some Malawian banks are refusing the Nzika digital ID wallet, Zodiak Online reported on 9 November 2026. The wallet launched on 16 September 2026. The Bankers Association of Malawi says it is still a pilot with one bank. The National Registration Bureau promised it the card's validity but set no compliance deadline. *Also under Access to services.*

- **How Kenya's digital birth registration system will work** — Daily Nation, 9 November 2026 KENYA

  Immigration PS Belio Kipsang told Kenyan MPs that birth and death certificate fees will be waived by Gazette notice, the Daily Nation reported on 9 November 2026. Within 30 days, civil registration is to link to the hospital system. Every newborn would then get a Unique Personal Identifier. Electronic birth notification is piloted in Nairobi and Bomet and is due to reach over 7,500 public hospitals. *Also under Registries.*

- **ECOWAS Heads of Immigration sign Freetown Declaration to mandate ENBIC acceptance by January 1, 2027** — ECOWAS Commission, 9 November 2026 WEST AFRICA

Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **Wave précise l'accès à PI-SPI au Sénégal et en Côte d'Ivoire** — BiFinances, 9 November 2026 SENEGAL CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  Wave announced on 6 November 2026 that its customers in Senegal and Côte d'Ivoire can use the PI-SPI instant-payment system from its app. Sending is free up to 8,000 FCFA a day and costs 0.8% plus taxes above that. Receiving is free. Withdrawing PI-SPI funds at an agent costs 1%.

- **Ethiopia's GDP Rebase Captures Growth in Digital Financial Services** — Tech Africa News, 9 November 2026 ETHIOPIA

  Ethiopia's rebased national accounts put 2024/25 GDP at 24.03 trillion birr, against 15.09 trillion under the previous series, Tech Africa News reported on 9 November 2026. The reference year moved from 2015/16 to 2024/25 with IMF technical assistance, and digital financial services and ride-hailing platforms entered the count. Preliminary 2025/26 GDP is 31.86 trillion birr. *Also under National statistics.*

- **MTN Group Earnings Outpace Revenue by 22.9% as Nigeria and Ghana Drive Q3 Growth** — Tech Africa News, 9 November 2026 NIGERIA GHANA SOUTH AFRICA AFRICA

  Summarised under Connectivity.

- **Côte d'Ivoire : ce que la nouvelle loi bancaire change pour les fintechs** — Banque Finance Magazine, 9 November 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

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- **Announcing the launch of the GSMA Innovation Fund for AI-Enabled Financial Health** — GSMA, 9 November 2026 GLOBAL

  Summarised under New investments.

Registries

- **This tech firm built the geospatial infrastructure behind Nigeria's door-level address system** — TechCabal, 9 November 2026 NIGERIA

  A profile published on 9 November 2026 describes the location data behind Nigeria's digital postcode system. The system launched on 1 October 2026 and gives codes to buildings or delivery units. Milsat chief executive Taslim Salaudeen says the firm supplies location data and is not an addressing company. *Also under Geospatial data.*

- **How Kenya's digital birth registration system will work** — Daily Nation, 9 November 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **RDC : un système connecté pour mieux organiser les interventions médicales** — wearetech.africa, 9 November 2026 DRC

  The DR Congo Ministry of Health announced on 8 November 2026 that the Etoile Bleue emergency medical response system will be inaugurated by the President, after a postponement in June 2026. It starts in Kinshasa and Matadi with a free 199 number, a mobile app, a regulation centre, 130 ambulances and 300 medical motorbikes. No launch date was given.

- **Built to Evolve: What HUSIKA Shows About Modular Digital Infrastructure** — GovStack, 9 November 2026 SOUTH SUDAN EAST AFRICA

  GovStack published an account on 9 November 2026 of HUSIKA, a platform that passes climate and early-warning information from producing institutions to media, authorities and communities. It lists active deployments in 11 countries, across web, SMS and Telegram. South Sudan's Meteorological Service used it in a journalist training and an official said it replaced door-to-door printed posters.

- **Administration numérique : Djibouti mise sur l'expérience de l'Azerbaïdjan** — wearetech.africa, 9 November 2026 DJIBOUTI

  Djibouti's Ministry of Labour signed an MoU with Azerbaijan's ASAN Service in Baku on 5 November 2026 on sharing expertise in digitalising public services on ASAN's one-stop-centre model. It follows a September 2025 study visit and an October 2025 inventory in which Djibouti listed 503 administrative procedures. Of these, 83 were prioritised for first-phase digitalisation.

- **"Build Once, Use Across Government": Mauritania's GovStack Journey** — GovStack, 9 November 2026 MAURITANIA

  Summarised under Standards.

- **Sierra Leone Begins Training Government ICT Officers on Website Management and Security** — Tech Africa News, 9 November 2026 SIERRA LEONE

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- **Moroccans abroad can now apply online for criminal record certificates** — Hespress, 9 November 2026 MOROCCO

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Technology

AI

- **Intelligence artificielle et langues nationales : Le Burkina Faso face au défi des données linguistiques** — leFaso.net, 9 November 2026 BURKINA FASO

  Summarised under Public debate and participation in policymaking.

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Capacity

Training and skills

- **Burkina Faso/Semaine du numérique 2026 : Des compétitions, formations gratuites et des innovations au programme de la 21e édition** — leFaso.net, 9 November 2026 BURKINA FASO

  The organising committee announced at a press conference in Ouagadougou on 9 November 2026 that the 21st Semaine du numérique will run from 24 to 27 November 2026 at the SIAO site. The theme is technological sovereignty and secure, inclusive digital transformation. The programme includes conferences, a start-up village, robot demonstrations, the RoboKids competition and free ICT training. *Also under Digital sovereignty*.

- **"Build Once, Use Across Government": Mauritania's GovStack Journey** — GovStack, 9 November 2026 MAURITANIA

  Summarised under Standards.

- **Sierra Leone Begins Training Government ICT Officers on Website Management and Security** — Tech Africa News, 9 November 2026 SIERRA LEONE

  Summarised under Cybersecurity.

Research institutions

- **Call for Stakeholder Inputs to the Vision for Open Research in Africa** — AUDA-NEPAD, 9 November 2026 AFRICA

  AUDA-NEPAD and the Science for Africa Foundation invited stakeholders, in a notice on file under 9 November 2026, to comment on a draft Vision for Open Research in Africa. The draft sets an ambition for an African-led open research ecosystem by 2034, aligned with STISA-2034. The consultation asks for views on relevance, challenges and priorities. *Also under Open data*.

Inclusion

Access to services

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Geospatial data

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Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

- **Ghana and US Explore Digital Investment Partnerships in Data Centres and Cloud Infrastructure** — Tech Africa News, 9 November 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Data Storage.

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Digital sovereignty

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country and region news.